A dark store needs about 1,133 orders a day to break even

Swiggy Instamart · Excel model from public results · Parth Dhawan · Oct 2026

114.5M orders · ₹691 average basket · 1,171 dark stores · Apr to Jun 2026 (Q1 FY27)

Close to break-even, and the basket is the fastest lever

~1,133

orders a day to break even

5.4% more than today's ~1,075 per store: about 58 extra orders a day.

−0.2%

margin today, as disclosed

After fixed costs, each order loses about ₹1.38 on a ₹691 basket.

₹85 cr

a quarter from a 10% bigger basket

+₹2.4 lakh per store per month, across all 1,171 stores.

Built only from public numbers, then checked



1. Disclosures

Orders, basket, revenue per order, margin, stores

2. One order

Revenue and every cost, per order

3. Calibrate

Fixed cost solved to hit the disclosed −0.2%

4. Break-even

Fixed cost a day ÷ profit per order

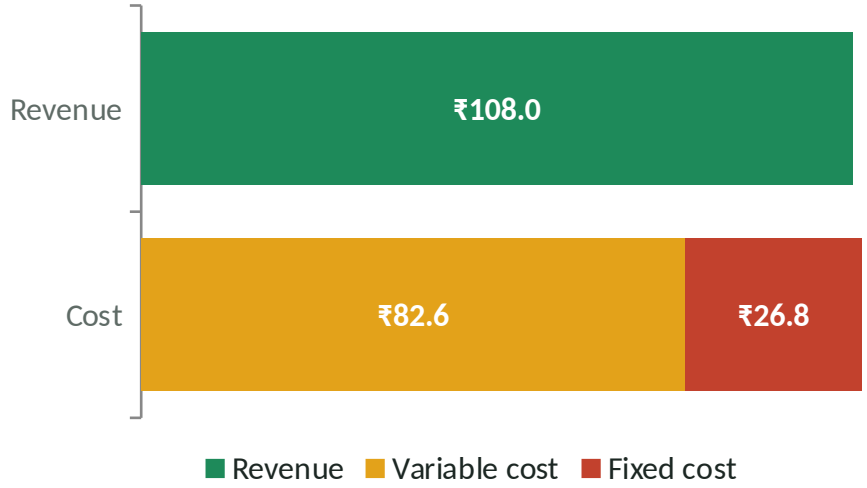
5. Checks

9 checks must read ALL PASS

Disclosed (Q1 FY27): ₹7,907 crore order value · 114.5M orders · ₹691 basket · ₹108 revenue per order · −0.2% margin · 1,171 stores.

Assumed, in yellow cells: the cost split (rider ₹45, picking ₹15, packaging ₹6 per order), fees, ad income and discounts. Change one and the whole workbook updates.

One order earns ₹108 and costs ₹109.38



Basket (average order value)	**₹691**
Revenue: margin 92 + fee 12 + ads 10 − discount 6	**₹108.00**
Variable: rider 45, picking 15, packaging 6, payment 8.3, wastage 8.3	**−₹82.58**
Profit per order before fixed cost	**₹25.42**
Fixed cost per order at today's volume	**−₹26.80**
Result per order (−0.2% of the basket)	**−₹1.38**

Fixed cost: rent, staff and power, about ₹8.6 lakh per store per month, spread over ~1,075 orders a day.

Each extra order adds ₹25; 58 more a day breaks even



~1,075

orders a day today: −₹1,485 a day per store

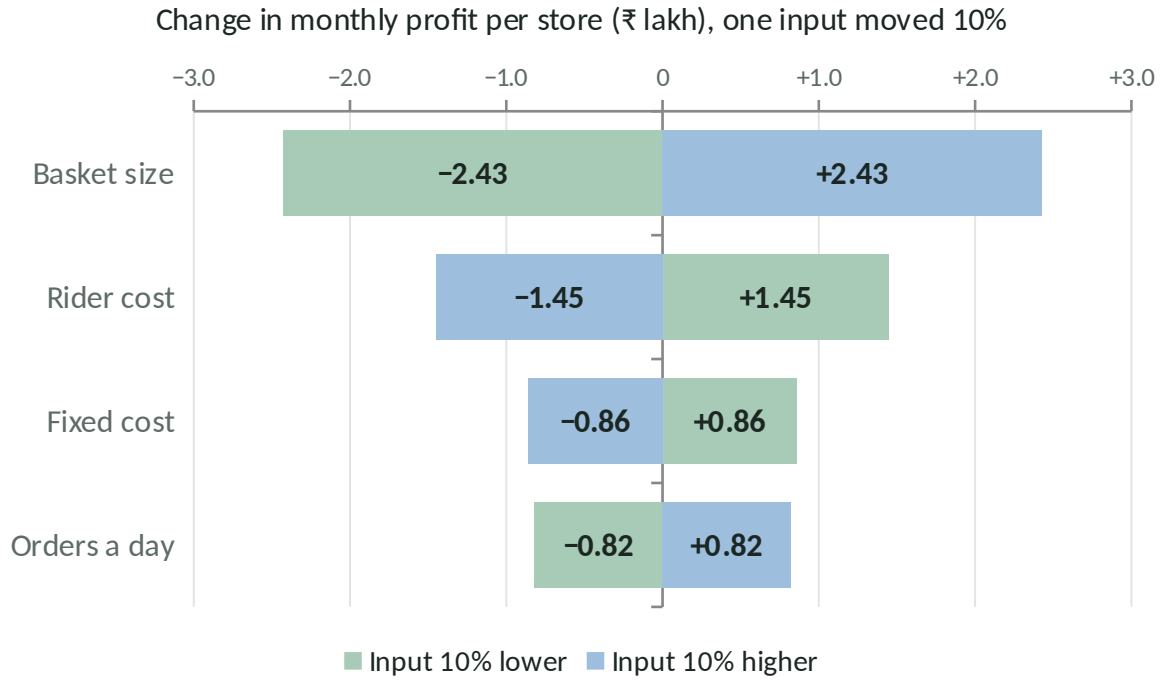
1,133

orders a day to break even: profit crosses ₹0

₹25.42

added by every extra order

Basket size moves profit most, then rider cost

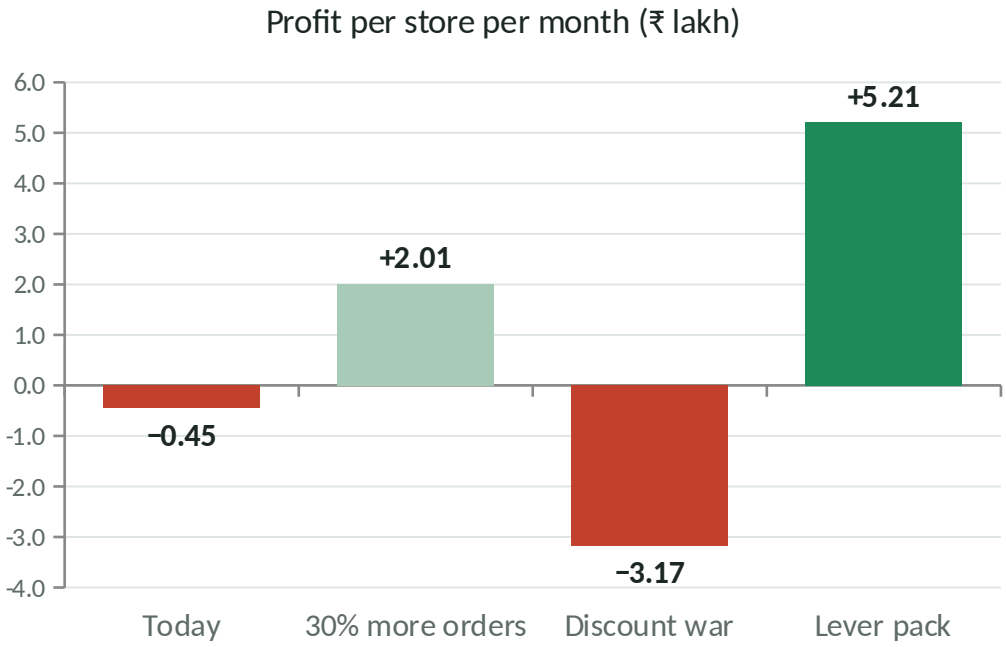


₹4.9 lakh

swing per store per month from a 10% move in basket size, double most other levers.

Volume ranks only fourth: a bigger basket earns more than more orders.

Small price moves beat chasing volume



30% more orders

Denser stores, nothing else changes: +0.7% margin.

Discount war

₹10 more discount wins 10% more orders, and the loss gets worse: −1.3% margin.

Lever pack

+₹60 basket, +₹5 ads, +₹3 fee, −₹3 rider at today's volume: +2.2% margin.

To reach a 2% margin, volume alone is the slow road

2,483

orders a day needed to reach a 2% margin through volume alone

+131% on today's ~1,075

2.2%

margin from the lever pack, at today's volume

no extra orders needed

Volume helps, but it has to more than double. Price, basket and cost moves get there faster and stack with any volume growth.

Next steps

1 Grow the basket first: bundles and minimum-order nudges. +10% is worth ~₹85 crore a quarter.

2 Batch deliveries to cut rider cost: ₹4.5 less per order adds ~₹1.45 lakh per store per month.

3 Do not buy volume with discounts: ₹10 more off for 10% more orders loses ₹2.7 lakh more per store a month.

4 Replace my cost-split assumptions with store-level data before acting on any number.

Happy to walk you through the model

Every number is a live formula, and the Checks sheet reads ALL PASS.

github.com/parthdhawan921-ops/dark-store-breakeven-model

parthdhawan921-ops.github.io/Parth_Personal/#darkstore

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